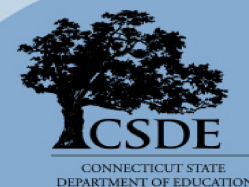


Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2022-23



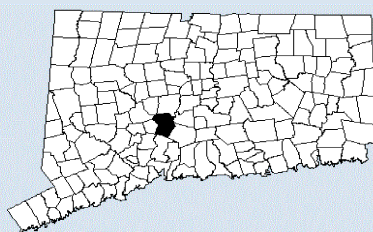
Cheshire School District

Dr. Jeffrey Solan, Superintendent • 203-250-2400 • www.cheshire.k12.ct.us/

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	13
Enrollment	4,208
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$19,163
Total Expenditures ¹	\$81,079,492

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2021-22 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2022-23 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2022 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.4
Male	2,149	51.1	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	394	9.4	5.2
Black or African American	146	3.5	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	376	8.9	30.0
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	135	3.2	4.5
White	3,153	74.9	47.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	124	2.9	9.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	702	16.7	42.4
Students with Disabilities ³	576	13.7	17.1

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	208	10.3	19	0.9
Male	230	11.0	81	3.7
Non-Binary	0	*	0	*
Black or African American	24	17.0	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	61	15.7	16	3.8
White	292	9.5	66	2.1
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	17	12.9	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	136	20.7	37	4.7
Students with Disabilities	113	19.9	43	6.2
District	438	10.6	100	2.3
State		20.0		7

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 167

Number of school-based arrests: 8

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Cheshire School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	274.5
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	34.2
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	55.5
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	130.3
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	4.7
School Level	21.4
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	6.6
Support Staff	4.9
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	21.7
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	28.9
School Nurses	8.9
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	201.7

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	2	0.5	1.3
Black or African American	4	1.0	4.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	8	1.9	4.9
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.2
White	402	96.6	88.7

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2021-22

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	13.5	13.2

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	9	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	21	100.0	28	96.6
White	230	99.6	263	99.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	6	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	43	100.0	53	100.0
Students with Disabilities	42	100.0	55	100.0
District	290	99.7	352	99.4
State		86.5		94.2

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	38	48.7
Emotional Disability	20	54.1
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	122	66.3
Other Health Impairment	90	73.2
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	32	88.9
District	313	61.6
State		68.6

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Cheshire School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	88	2.1	2.4
Emotional Disability	37	0.9	1.0
Intellectual Disability	26	0.6	0.6
Learning Disability	186	4.5	6.3
Other Health Impairment	124	3.0	3.4
Other Disabilities	41	1.0	1.1
Speech/Language Impairment	39	0.9	1.9
All Disabilities	541	13.1	16.7

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	8	1.5	8.1
Private Schools or Other Settings	13	2.4	4.7

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2021-22

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$50,018,322	\$11,822	\$12,671
Support services - students	\$6,793,363	\$1,623	\$1,558
Support services - instruction	\$3,133,973	\$749	\$837
Support services - general administration	\$1,036,602	\$248	\$463
Support services - school based administration	\$3,983,179	\$952	\$1,133
Central and other support services	\$2,279,515	\$545	\$716
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$8,423,151	\$2,013	\$1,893
Student transportation services	\$4,361,346	\$1,245	\$1,464
Food services	.	.	\$5
Enterprise operations	\$1,050,041	\$251	\$186
Total	\$81,079,492	\$19,163	\$20,165

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2021-22

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$7,143,151	36.1	29.0
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$2,830,498	14.3	10.6
Other Salaries	\$2,081,225	10.5	10.1
Employee Benefits	\$3,713,983	18.8	13.1
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$836,378	4.2	5.9
Special Education Tuition	\$1,936,382	9.8	21.8
Supplies	\$270,143	1.4	0.7
Property Services	\$84,915	0.4	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$893,604	4.5	8.1
Equipment	.	.	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$1,200	0.0	0.1
Total	\$19,791,479	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		24.4	24.9

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2021-22

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	84.2
State	12.8
Federal	2.5
Tuition & Other	0.5

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Cheshire School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Asian	189	83.1	189	85.8	76	80.7
Black or African American	66	70.1	65	61.6	32	62.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	161	75.8	161	72.9	59	69.9
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	79	74.6	79	73.2	33	71.1
White	1,605	78.4	1,601	76.5	689	76.0
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	85	71.1	85	73.6	23	68.7
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	2,015	78.5	2,010	76.6	866	75.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	319	70.6	318	68.2	131	69.1
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,781	79.6	1,777	77.9	758	76.4
Students with Disabilities	256	57.3	254	52.9	112	53.7
Students without Disabilities	1,844	81.1	1,841	79.7	777	78.4
High Needs	551	66.8	548	64.3	225	63.8
Non-High Needs	1,549	82.3	1,547	80.8	664	79.2
District	2,100	78.2	2,095	76.5	889	75.3

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	80.9	74.3	71.6	91.5	1,238	79.8
Curl Up	91.9	87.9	88.2	97.5	1,239	91.4
Push Up	81.3	73.7	70.9	93.1	1,238	80.0
Mile Run/PACER	85.0	73.8	72.4	74.8	1,239	76.6
All Tests - District	61.6	51.0	48.3	69.4	1,237	57.8
All Tests - State	51.5	46.0	44.1	41.1		45.5

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Cheshire School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2021-22	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	9	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	22	86.4
White	296	95.9
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	61	91.8
Students with Disabilities	68	73.5
District	380	95.3
State		88.9

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2021-22 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	95.4	219	63.1
Male	*	171	57.6
Non-Binary	*	0	*
Black or African American	86.4	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	98.0	27	54.0
White	96.0	300	60.6
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	94.8	34	35.4
Students with Disabilities	74.2	6	6.2
District	95.5	390	60.5
State	95.2		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2022	Class of 2021
	Entrance ⁵	Persistence ⁶
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	88.9	94.5
Male	77.5	93.0
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	82.9	94.4
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	74.2	91.9
Students with Disabilities	65.0	80.0
District	83.3	93.9
State	66.1	87.7

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Cheshire School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	78.2	75	50.0	50	100.0	63.9
	High Needs Students	66.8	75	44.5	50	89.0	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	76.5	75	50.0	50	100.0	59.7
	High Needs Students	64.3	75	42.9	50	85.7	48.9
Science Performance Index	All Students	75.3	75	50.0	50	100.0	61.6
	High Needs Students	63.8	75	42.5	50	85.1	51.1
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	68.9%	100%	68.9	100	68.9	57.2%
	High Needs Students	58.5%	100%	58.5	100	58.5	52.5%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	73.2%	100%	73.2	100	73.2	61.8%
	High Needs Students	66.5%	100%	66.5	100	66.5	55.5%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	65.7%	100%	32.9	50	65.7	55.3%
	Oral	70.2%	100%	35.1	50	70.2	56.1%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	10.6%	<=5%	38.7	50	77.4	20.0%
	High Needs Students	19.1%	<=5%	21.9	50	43.8	28.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	99.5%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	90.4%
	% Meeting Benchmark	60.5%	75%	40.3	50	80.6	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		95.7%	94%	50.0	50	100.0	82.4%
4-year Graduation All Students (2022 Cohort)		95.3%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	88.9%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2020 Cohort)		91.4%	94%	97.2	100	97.2	85.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2022)		83.3%	75%	100.0	100	100.0	66.1%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		97.5% 57.8%	75%	38.5	50	77.1	93.0% 45.5%
Arts Access		58.9%	60%	49.1	50	98.1	54.5%
Accountability Index				1200.7	1450	82.8	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	66.8	8.2	16.6	
Math Performance Index Gap	75.0	64.3	10.7	18.0	
Science Performance Index Gap	75.0	63.8	11.2	17.8	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	91.4%	2.6%	8.7%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	98.1
	High Needs Students	94.8
Math	All Students	97.9
	High Needs Students	94.3
Science	All Students	97.7
	High Needs Students	93.7

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 63.0

State: 49.6

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Cheshire School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The Cheshire Public Schools created 16 strategic goals in 2011 which were slated to be reviewed in 2021. The pandemic derailed those plans so working with the community to establish revised goals was a focus of the 2021-2022 school year. There were meetings held at each school to connect with parents about the goals of the district. Families provided feedback to district leaders on which goals were most critical. We also used this opportunity to solicit feedback on the improvement of school programs and coached families on strategies to best support their children at home. The Board of Education met in the fall of 2022 and formally adopted a revised set of goals for the future.

The Cheshire Public Schools continued to leverage new strategies identified over the pandemic to connect with our community. Over the 2022-23 school year, the district had a very active social media presence on Twitter, Instagram, and Facebook in order to share timely, pertinent information about our schools. We finalized our newly created webpage that was devoted exclusively to pandemic-related resources and instructional supports. Parent communication was a top priority as we strived to support parents and students. District communication included email, school messenger, social media, video messages from the Superintendent, Board of Education live-streamed meetings, and a newly established email hotline for parents and community members to ask questions about what is happening in our schools. Many parents and community members cited our effective communications strategies to learn about the referendum for new schools. Numerous in-person and virtual meetings were held to provide updates on the progress of this proposal. The town eventually voted in favor of constructing two new schools in Cheshire. We continue to use these same communications strategies to inform the community about the progress of this plan.

Our district improvement was focused exclusively on meeting the academic and social-emotional needs of our students. Our "Bounce Forward" Plan with our federal funding focused on providing resources to our students and professional development for our staff. On the SEL side, we focused on regular communication and support to students and families. We provided training to staff including Mental Health First Aid and responsive classroom coaching. Our high school sophomores were among some of the first students in America to be trained in Teen Mental Health First Aid. Academically, we provided professional development and coaching in Accelerated Learning (a focus on maintaining student progress on grade level material rather than trying to recapture lost time). This work supports all students, particularly those students with more significant needs.

Our efforts to address student attendance focused on communication and education for families. A student who misses 18 days per year loses a full year of learning over the course of a decade. That is a statistic that we found powerful and supportive of maintaining improved attendance with families.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

CPS actively participates in the Open Choice program, as well as magnet opportunities. Nearly 40 students from New Haven are enrolled in Cheshire schools. We believe that these exchanges provide enriching experiences for all of our students. As such, we increased our open choice enrollment by over 10% in 2022-23 from the previous year.

At the elementary level, we build a classroom community based on equality, respect, and understanding of each other's unique backgrounds. Grades K-2 study and compare cultures. In Grades 3-6, culture, diversity, and understanding perspective are embedded in units on local history, and comparative cultures around the world.

At the middle school, the language arts curriculum is based on an independent reading program where students choose a wide variety of texts and authors of all different races and ethnicities. Discussion around the perspective of each author and the experience of each individual in the context of society inform the reader and class as a whole.

CHS engages in a variety of academic and co-curricular pursuits to reduce ethnic, racial, and economic isolation. Students in our English classes explore connections between fictional texts and real-world events, which offer opportunities to explore race, socioeconomic issues, and isolation. The department contextualizes literary choices within their social and political contexts. Our social studies classes focus on themes that include human rights struggles around the globe, cultural diversity as part of our American national identity, and the struggle for freedom, equality, and social justice. We were also among the first high schools in Connecticut to offer the new Black and Latino Studies Course. Clubs like Rams Against Racism Club and the Gender-Sexuality Alliance Club continued to play active roles in our community.

Districtwide, we continue to work on our SEL goal including cultural awareness with partners such as SCSU, Meriden Public Schools, and SERC. We actively recruit a diverse workforce and work to educate our staff and community on the importance of an inclusive and diverse environment for our students. We are excited to be participating in the ACES program to diversify our workforce. Our first candidate from the program starts in 2023-24.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Cheshire School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Cheshire Board of Education Policy states that each student in the school district shall be supplied with the appropriate level of material and resources to assure adequate opportunities to achieve academic success. Schools develop their resource needs based on curricular programs and annual strategic initiatives in the school strategic plan. Those strategic initiatives are connected to the major objectives set forth by the Board in its strategic plan. This process assures there is continuity among individual school plans. Principals and central office administrators work collaboratively to develop budgets for instructional resources to support teaching and learning. Although supplies are allocated based on curriculum needs, enrollment, and a per pupil average at each grade level, in some years a school may receive greater funding than others due to changes in enrollment, specific needs, or unique circumstances. Students with special needs are evaluated on an individual basis and decisions to provide adequate support and to purchase appropriate materials, supplies, and equipment to meet their individual education programs are based on that information.